

Instagram

Read [README.md](#) first — it has the link format and the link test that this guide assumes you have done.

Instagram runs on Meta's advertising system, so paid campaigns are built in the same Ads Manager as Facebook. What differs is organic content: Instagram allows clickable links in far fewer places than Facebook does.

What works today: an Instagram ad's destination URL, a Story link sticker, or the profile bio link carries the property link to the client's website, and the enquiry reaches the CRM.

What does not: Instagram Instant Forms. Leads stay inside Meta.

1. Where a link can go on Instagram

This is the constraint that shapes everything else.

Place	Clickable	Use it for
Ad destination URL	Yes	Paid campaigns
Story link sticker	Yes	One link per Story slide
Profile bio	Yes — up to five links	The current featured property
Feed post caption	No	Point people to the bio link
Reel caption	No	Same
Comments	No	Same

A URL typed into a caption is plain text. People cannot tap it and will not retype it. Plan organic Instagram content around the bio link and Stories.

2. Accounts

Make the account professional

A personal account cannot be linked to a Page or advertised from. In the Instagram app: **Settings and privacy** → **Account type and tools** → **Switch to professional account**. Choose the business category. Add the contact email, phone number, and address that match the property page.

Connect it to the Facebook Page

The connection has to be the business link between the Page and the professional account. There are two ways to make it:

From Instagram: profile → **Edit profile** → under **Public business information**, tap **Page** → **Connect or create** → select the client's Page.

From the Facebook Page: **Page Settings** → **Linked accounts** → **Instagram** → **Connect account**.

Do not use **Accounts Center** → **Add accounts** for this. That links a personal Facebook profile to Instagram for sharing and single sign-in. It does not create the Page-to-professional-account link that advertising needs. This trips people up regularly.

Confirm access

In Meta Business Suite → **Settings**, confirm the business portfolio lists the Instagram account alongside the Page and ad account, and that the person building the campaign has access to all three. If the Instagram account is missing here, Ads Manager will not offer it as an ad identity.

3. Organic content

Bio link

Profile → **Edit profile** → **Links** → **Add external link**. Paste the full `https://` link with its parameters and give it a short title such as the property name. Up to five links are supported; more than one appears as a small menu.

Use `utm_medium=social` and a campaign key naming the placement, for example `utm_content=ig-bio`, so bio traffic is distinguishable from ad traffic.

Update this whenever the featured property changes. A stale bio link pointing at a sold property is the most common quiet failure on Instagram.

Story link sticker

Create the Story.

Add the **Link** sticker and paste the full link.

Give the sticker readable text such as "View details".

Post it, then tap your own sticker to confirm the destination.

One link sticker per slide. For several properties, use several slides. Stories expire after 24 hours — add the important ones to a Highlight so the link stays reachable.

Feed posts and Reels

Write the caption so it points at the bio link ("details in bio"), and keep the bio link pointing at the property the post is about. Everything the ad or post claims about price, availability, and location must match the property page.

4. Run an ad

Instagram ads are built in Meta Ads Manager. The campaign structure and settings are the same as [facebook-setup.md](#) section 3 — read it — with three differences:

Use a different link. `utm_source=instagram` , not `facebook` . A single ad cannot honestly label both.

Placements: turn off Advantage+ placements and select Instagram placements only — Instagram Feed, and Stories or Reels if you have creative built for them. Exclude Facebook, Messenger, Threads, and Audience Network.

Identity: at the ad level, select the client's Instagram account. If it is missing, the Page-to-account link in section 2 is not complete.

Objective is still **Traffic**, performance goal is still **maximise number of link clicks**, and the **Housing** special ad category applies exactly as it does on Facebook.

Instagram Feed, Stories, and Reels crop very differently. Check every retained placement in **Ad preview** before publishing, and make sure the call to action is not covered by the interface.

5. After launch

Run the link test from the live ad preview on a real phone, including Instagram's in-app browser. Confirm the enquiry arrives with source `instagram` and the expected campaign key, and that the email reached every recipient.

If you are also running Facebook, keep the two sets of results separate. Merging them hides which platform actually produces enquiries.

6. Problems

What you see	Cause	Fix
Instagram account missing from Identity	The professional account is not linked to the Page, or was linked through Accounts Center	Redo the connection from Page Settings → Linked accounts
Cannot switch to professional	Account is under 18 or restricted	Resolve on the account itself; there is no workaround
Bio link is not clickable	Typed into the bio text instead of the Links field	Use Edit profile → Links
Link sticker unavailable	The Story is a repost, or the app is out of date	Update the app; create the Story natively
CRM source shows <code>facebook</code> for Instagram traffic	The Facebook link was reused	Split the campaigns; use the Instagram link
CRM source shows <code>unknown</code>	<code>utm_source</code> misspelled	It must be exactly <code>instagram</code> , lowercase
Enquiries from Stories but no campaign key	The sticker link had no parameters	Rebuild the sticker link with the full parameter set

7. Instant Forms

Instagram Instant Forms are the same Meta product as Facebook's, sharing the same ad account and the same lead storage. Nothing has been built to collect them, so leads would stay inside Meta. See [native-lead-forms.md](#) for what that work involves.

Sources

[Connect a professional Instagram account and a Facebook Page](#)

[Add or change the Facebook Page connected to your Instagram professional account](#)

[Traffic objective](#) — confirmed 7 August 2026

Multiple bio links: introduced by Meta in April 2023, [reported at launch](#), still five as of August 2026

Meta and Instagram Help Centre pages render their content with JavaScript and could not be read by an automated check. Menu paths above reflect the current app; confirm them on the device you are using.